Sonya Trau: Queensland Practice Lead

Systemic Leadership Coach | Team Coach | Strategic Facilitator

Sonya is a highly experienced leader in Australia's coaching and leadership development industry, with over 17 years of experience and more than 20,000 hours dedicated to leadership coaching, development and executive facilitation. As the Queensland team lead for Leading Well, Sonya specialises in empowering leaders, teams and organisations to achieve sustained performance and wellbeing through a systemic and holistic approach.

CORE EXPERTISE

- **Systemic Leadership Development**: Designing and delivering high impact, tailored programs for individuals and leadership teams that build individual growth, team dynamics, and organisational systems for sustainable high performance.
- **Systemic Executive Coaching**: Developing leaders addressing their individual growth but also their interactions within their teams, organisations, and the larger system in which they operate.
- **Facilitation**: Designing and facilitating strategic-to-operational workshop experiences that create clarity, alignment and quality strategic outcomes.
- **Mentoring Programs**: Facilitation of high-quality end-to-end mentoring program to retain, engage and develop your talent with the help of your existing pool of experienced leaders as mentors.

APPROACH & STYLE

Sonya's unique value lies in her ability to integrate holistic leadership and wellbeing into organisational development, ensuring lasting performance. A dynamic and engaging presence, Sonya captivates audiences with her energy and depth, motivating leaders to challenge their perspectives while equipping them with practical tools to achieve impactful results. Her expertise in forging aligned and productive executive teams enables them to navigate complex challenges collaboratively and effectively.

CLIENTS & PROJECTS

Sonya's clients include Qld State Government Departments, Local Councils (including Brisbane City, Redland City, Toowoomba, Cook Shire), Universities (including the University of QLD, Laureate and USQ), for purpose organisations including (including Uniting Church of Qld, Wesley Mission Qld, Aust College of Rural and Remote Medicine) and corporates including Global Payments, BHP, Nespresso and many others. Her projects have ranged from team and individual leadership coaching, strategic facilitation, as well as designing and delivering high impact blended multi-agency, multi-level leadership programs across government and corporates.

PROFESSIONAL BACKGROUND

With over 25 years in management and executive roles within multinational corporations and global brands prior to her coaching career, Sonya brings a practical and results-driven perspective to her work. Her previous roles include: Scientist with CSIRO, Metallurgical Engineer (BHP), Asia Pacific Leadership roles with Microsoft Corporation, Non-Executive Board Member with Brisbane tech start-ups . Sonya's technical background makes her particularly effective in coaching leaders in the engineering and technology sectors, connecting deeply with their unique challenges and opportunities.

PASSION & PHILOSOPHY

Sonya is passionate about building leadership capability by fostering systemic thinking, relational intelligence and personal awareness. She believes that holistic leadership—rooted in both personal growth and organisational wellbeing—is key to achieving positive and sustained results.

Sonya's qualifications include:

- Master Coach Practitioner (EIA), and Senior Team Coach (ITCA) European Coaching and Mentoring Council
- EMCC Foundation Member Asia Pacific Region 2018
- Certified International Systemic Team Coach, Academy of Executive Coaching
- Systemic Team Coach L1&L2 Certified, Institute of Coaching and Mentoring (London)
- Accredited Leading Well Systemic Leadership Coach
- Certified in The Leadership Circle, Human Synergistics, Team Management Systems, DISC Adv, Team Connect 360, GLWS L2
- Masters of Business Administration (QUT)
- Bachelor of Science – First Class Honours (UQ)

Here's an example of what Sonya's clients have to say about their experience with her:

"It's my absolute pleasure to acknowledge the work that Sonya did facilitating our 2 day off-site this week. You were brave enough to take us out into a space that we weren't ready to go - well maybe we thought we weren't ready to go but we desperately needed to. When you can do that with us, then I think you can do it with anyone. So, thank you for reminding me of the real importance of bringing people together and having important conversations, not just about the work, also about how we work. Thanks for making a space where it was possible and thanks for also getting us the outcomes we wanted in the two days. Great work!"

Sally Stannard, Director General, Queensland Department of Transport and Main Roads

"Wesley Mission Queensland engaged Sonya Trau from Leading Well to provide executive leadership workshops for our organisation, in the healthcare sector. I have personal experience of Leading Well (Sonya Trau) over the last 2 years both as a participant in a high impact leadership development program and as a Learning and Development professional engaging Leading Well in a program involving executive leaders. I have found Leading Well (Sonya Trau) to be:

- *highly experienced in engaging with different personality and learning styles*
- *able to quickly establish and maintain strong rapport and engagement with senior executives*
- *ensure that the executive experience is highly engaging and pitched at exactly the right level*
- *highly flexible and adaptable to ensure that the best possible program and workshop outcomes are achieved, in an unpredictable, changing environment*
- *very professional and adaptable to organisational and individual needs*

  I can highly recommend Sonya Trau to any organisation who wants to increase leadership capability at the Executive level. "

Anneline Kinnear, General Manager, Wesley Mission Qld

"Sonya was instrumental in facilitating our leadership group through a recent team building and planning session. Her extensive industry knowledge, direction and choice of leadership and communication frameworks set the tone and guided us to a successful outcome I believe we would not have achieved on our own. Sonya understood our team dynamics and enabled us to take positive steps to improve our communication and ability to work together to achieve common goals. With her warm and inclusive approach, Sonya enabled everyone to feel "safe" to discuss items which may have proved contentious without her direction. Thanks to Sonya, the session was a success and all involved ended the day with a new motivation for change and working together more effectively and collaboratively. I highly recommend Sonya to provide support to your leadership group and facilitate any strategy or planning session for your business."

Tanya Manderson, Human Resource Manager, ASG Group

"I feel Sonya is with me at every step on the journey, reflecting back to me, bringing discipline into my thinking and distilling complexity. Sonya has been instrumental in supporting me to build a capable and competent executive team, through solving wicked problems while staying focussed on the right horizon. It's an absolute privilege to work with her, she is simply brilliant!

Heather DenHouting, CEO Uniting Church (Qld)